

Leasing Platform Decision — Saudi Arabia

SaaS vs ERP platform vs custom build — graphical & tabular comparison, weighted scorecard, and reasoned recommendations

The right answer depends on which leasing business you run

Local Saudi-native SaaS / build

SHORT-TERM RENTAL

Tajeer + ZATCA native; Absher e-sign; live in weeks

Annata A365 / CarPro LeaseProXL

CORPORATE + FINANCE LEASING

ERP-grade lifecycle & SAMA audit fit; decide via 6-week RFP

Custom build (gated)

LEASING AS DIFFERENTIATOR

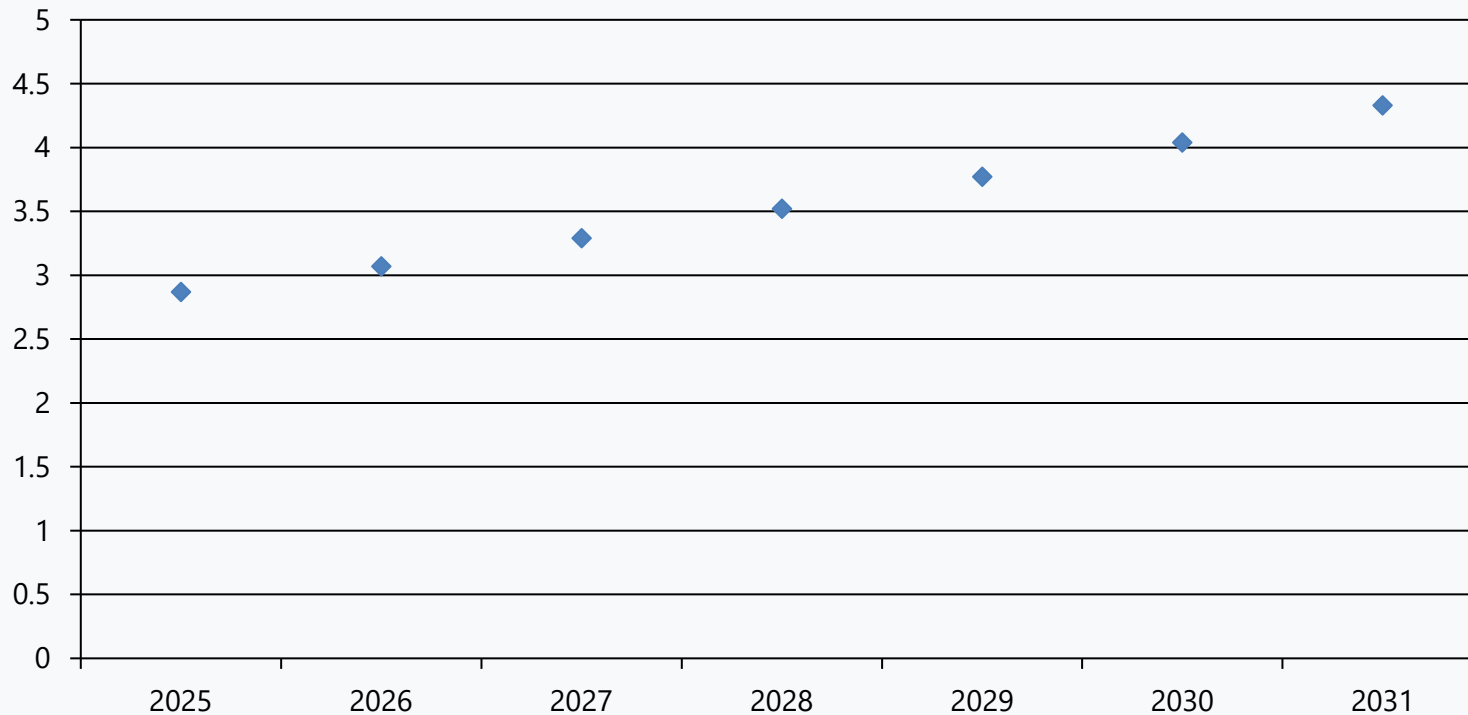
Highest weighted score (3.85/5) — only with a funded 3-year team

Weighted scorecard (corporate-leasing weights): Custom 3.85 · Annata A365 3.42 · Local SaaS 3.35 · CarPro 2.65 · Rentey 1.45 — yet the recommendation is NOT 'build first': custom owes its lead to long-horizon criteria that only pay off if a product team is funded for 3+ years.

- Regulatory gates (ZATCA Phase 2, Tajeer, SAMA) are the decisive filter — no international option clears all of them natively.
- RED FLAG — CarPro is mid-merger (Emotion, Mar 2025): written Rentway-vs-CarPro roadmap required. Rentey: thinnest evidence base — excluded pending references.

Saudi rental-leasing demand compounds at ~7–9% under Vision 2030

KSA car rental + leasing market (USD bn) — 7.09%
CAGR (Research&Markets 2026–2031)



WHAT'S DRIVING IT

- SAR 7.5bn (FY23) → 11.7bn (FY28E), 9.2% CAGR — Aljazira Capital
- Long-term leasing growing faster than short-term; corporate + government fleet outsourcing
- Fragmented: top-3 players hold only ~25% share
- Regional-HQ mandate (2024) → new corporate lease demand

Three regulatory gates decide the winner: ZATCA, Tajeer, SAMA

ZATCA — Fatoora Phase 2

API clearance + 24-hour reporting, cryptographic stamp & QR. Wave threshold now SAR 1M turnover; Wave 24 (SAR 375K) cited for 2026 — verify with ZATCA.

Tajeer — Transport General Authority

Mandatory unified e-contract for car rental: 1.77M contracts issued in Q4 2025 alone. API setup SAR 15,000 + ~SAR 2.25/tx; renter e-signs via Absher OTP.

SAMA — Finance Leasing

Finance lease is a licensed activity (Finance Companies Control Law + Finance Lease Law M/48): capital, governance, cloud outsourcing non-objection.

PDPL + sector residency

GDPR-style law, but SAMA/CST/NCA rules keep regulated financial workloads effectively in-Kingdom — confirm hosting explicitly with any SaaS.

Language & identity

Arabic-first contracts and branch UI; Absher/NAFATH flow is the Tajeer completion path.

Consequence: international platforms clear these gates only with middleware — local SaaS and custom builds clear them natively.

PART II — The Four Options

Who they are, what they prove, what to verify — evidence standard: 2+ independent sources per claim

CarPro (now Emotion) — deepest lease pedigree, now mid-merger

- Founded 1992 · HQ Amsterdam · rental + leasing + subscription modules
- Clients incl. Hertz, Europcar, LeasePlan, VW Financial Services (vendor claim); scale claim: 85+ countries, 1M+ vehicles, 500+ partners
- LeaseProXL: lease quotations, flexible invoicing (corporate/combined), AR + aging + collections, cashiers, multi-currency, fleet status
- **RED FLAG — ownership churn: sold to Ibérica (Jul 2020) → merged with Jimpisoft/Rentway into Emotion Mobility (Mar 2025); consolidation underway**
- **RED FLAG — no native ZATCA/Tajeer/Absher layer; requires middleware or a local integrator**

RFP DISQUALIFIERS TO TEST

- Written product roadmap: Rentway vs CarPro — which line survives?
- Two reference customers of similar fleet size
- ZATCA middleware plan + cost, in writing
- Data-egress clause and hosting location

Rentey (Qoad) — promising SaaS, but the thinnest evidence base

- All-in-one rental platform: reservations + payments, built-in CRM, fleet optimization, analytics, mobile access
- Part of Qoad product family (QFleets for corporate car sharing) — vertical SaaS vendor
- **RED FLAG — public footprint limited to a single vendor page: no verifiable references, funding, or headcount found**
- **RED FLAG — no public evidence of ZATCA, Tajeer, or SAMA awareness; Arabic status unknown**
- Comparably-positioned tools exist (Rently, Renthub) — Rentey must earn its slot

RE-STATEMENT BAR

- 2+ same-size operator references, in KSA/GCC
- Live sandbox on our data
- ZATCA/Tajeer statement in writing
- Financial viability evidence (funding/size)

Annata A365 — ERP-grade leasing on Dynamics 365

- Founded 2001 · HQ Kópavogur, Iceland · 15 offices, 4 continents · Microsoft Inner Circle ISV (top 1% of Dynamics partners)
- A365 = ERP + CRM + DMS on Dynamics 365 F&O; Rental & Subscription modules cover cradle-to-grave vehicle lifecycle
- Enterprise integration: GL, fixed assets, audit trails, Copilot/Azure; MEA delivery via partners (SHEA, Confiz — Sep 2025)
- D365 ships a Saudi ZATCA localization (CSID onboarding) — integration work sits with the implementer
- **CAUTION — no Riyadh office; delivery quality depends on the local partner chosen**

VERIFY IN RFP

- KSA D365 e-invoicing reference implementations
- In-Kingdom hosting posture (Azure region)
- Named Saudi delivery team, not fly-in model
- Ijara-compatible contract configuration depth

Custom build — total control and Saudi-native compliance, at a price

- Control: own schema, own roadmap, ijara-compatible contract modelling, no per-seat licence tax, exit on your terms
- Compliance-native from day one: ZATCA Phase 2 APIs, Tajeer + Absher/NAFATH, Arabic-first UI, PDPL in-Kingdom hosting
- TCO logic: front-loaded build, flattening curve ONLY if maintained (15–20%/yr of build) by a durable team — else it decays into legacy
- **Reality: a leasing core (contracts, SAMA reporting, fleet lifecycle, billing) is a multi-million-SAR, 6–12+ month programme — generic ERP build figures do not transfer**
- Risk swap: vendor-dependence disappears; team/key-person (bus factor) risk appears — keep 2+ owners on every core module

Why a custom build earns its slot — six benefits, priced honestly

1 · Compliance-native

ZATCA Phase 2 + Tajeer + Absher/NAFATH built in — no middleware, no third-party integration tax. Faster, safer go-live.

2 · Shariah by design

Ijara ownership-transfer schedules, penalty-free late terms, per-contract structuring — not configurable at any packaged vendor.

3 · No licence tax

40 active users ≈ SAR 1.1M+ licence spend avoided over 5 yrs (est.); costs scale with compute, not headcount.

4 · Data sovereignty

Own schema + in-Kingdom hosting choice → PDPL/SAMA posture you control; clean full-fidelity export, forever.

5 · Roadmap sovereignty

Features land when YOU need them — eliminates vendor roadmap, renewal (9–12%/yr) and merger risk (see CarPro→Emotion).

6 · AI & data moat

Pricing / utilization / risk models trained on your fleet data — proprietary advantage no packaged system can match.

THE PRICE OF OWNERSHIP — SAR 2.5–3.5M build + 15–20%/yr upkeep · 6–12+ months to live · a funded 3-year product team · phased MVP behind a capability gate. Custom wins the long game only under these conditions.

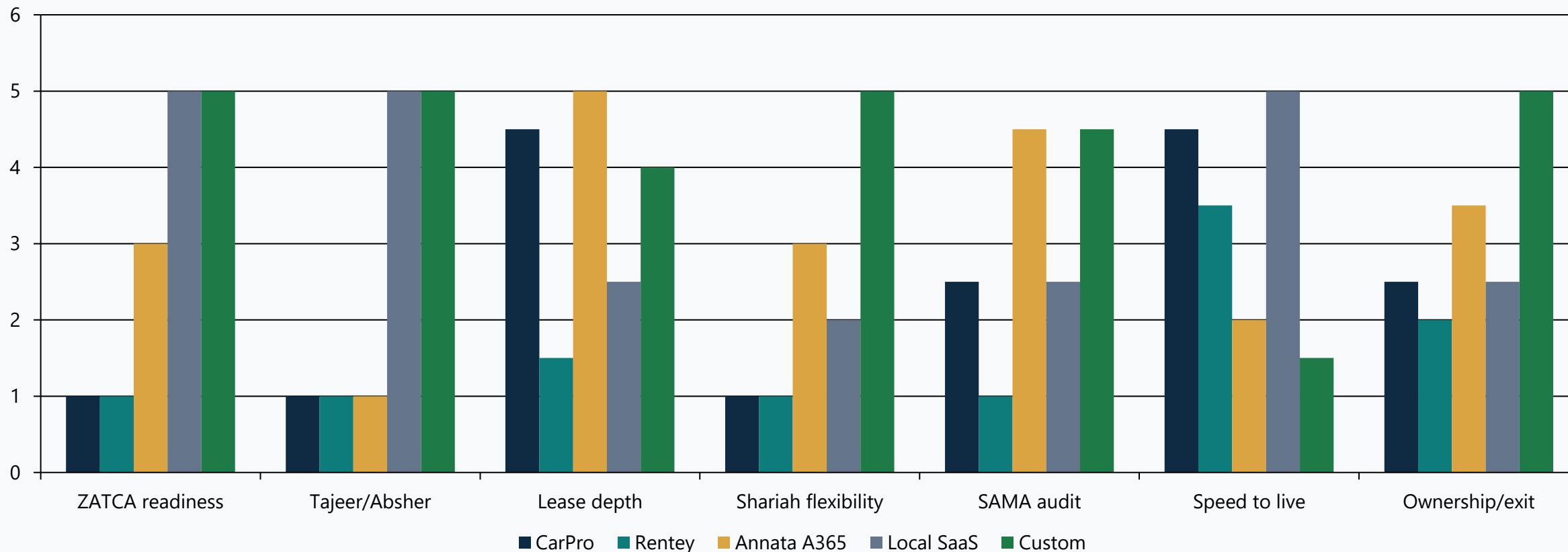
Capability matrix — no option clears every Saudi gate natively

Dimension	CarPro LeaseProXL	Rentey (Qoad)	Annata A365	Local SaaS	Custom build
ZATCA Phase 2	Middleware	Unknown	Via D365 SA module	Native	Native (build)
Tajeer + Absher	Not native	Unknown	Not native	Native	Native (build)
Finance-lease depth	LeaseProXL	Rental focus	Full lifecycle	Rental-grade	As designed
Ijara / Shariah config	No	No	Configurable	Usually no	Full control
SAMA audit fit	Partial	No	ERP-grade	Partial	If designed
Arabic/RTL + NAFATH	Partial	Unknown	D365 multi-lang	Native	Native (build)
Time to go-live	4–8 wks	Unknown	3–6+ months	2–8 weeks	6–12+ months
5-yr TCO shape	Rises (seats)	Rises (seats)	High but flatter	Rises (sub)	Flattens if run
Exit / lock-in	Untested	Untested	D365 export	SaaS terms	Own schema
In-Kingdom hosting	Ask vendor	Ask vendor	Azure — verify	Confirm	Your control

'Unknown' = could not verify publicly (documented gap). Azure KSA-region availability to be verified with Microsoft at RFP stage.

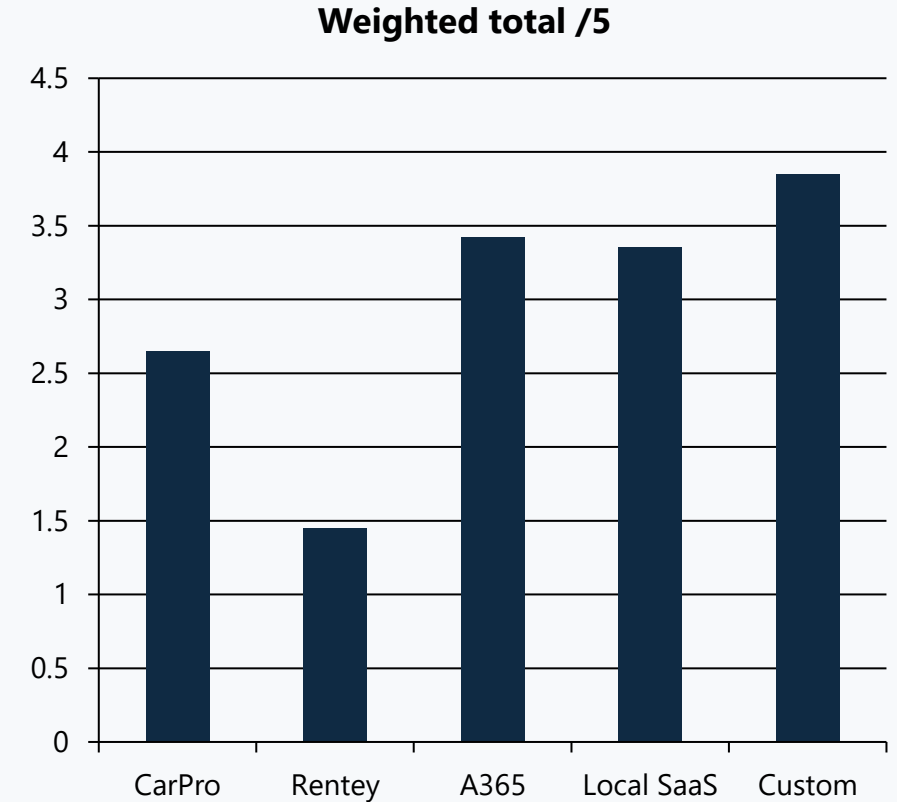
Capability profiles — strengths differ; verdict depends on scenario

Capability scoring 0–5 (evidence-anchored assessment, 30 Sep 2026)



Weighted scorecard — Custom leads numerically, execution risk decides otherwise

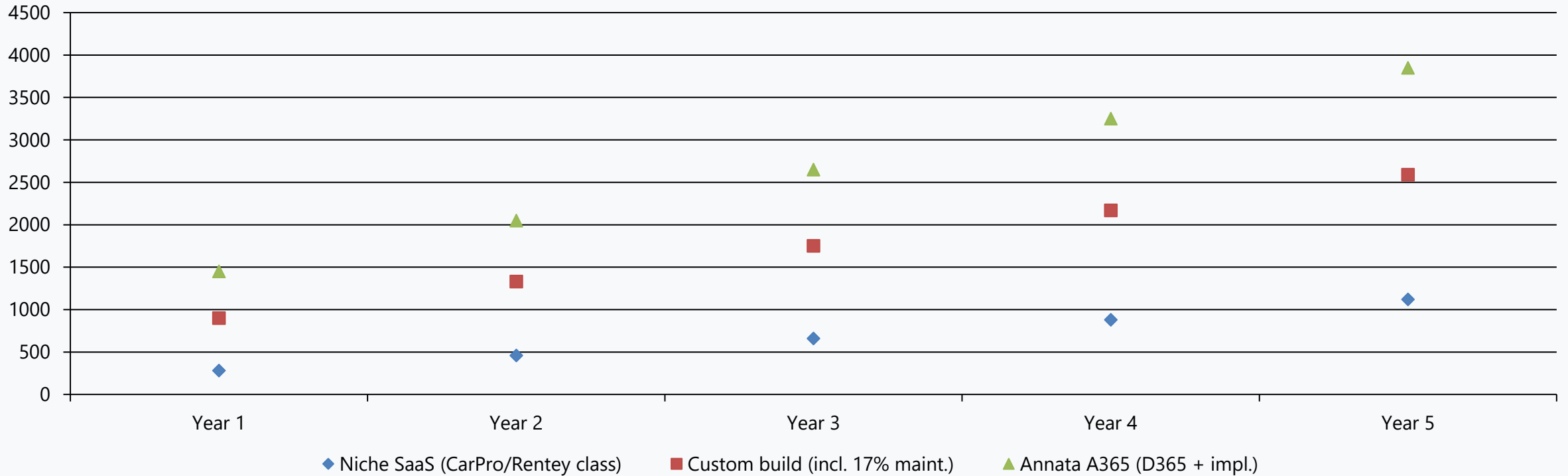
Criterion (weight)	CarPro	Rentey	A365	Local SaaS	Custom
Regulatory readiness — 25%	1.00	1.00	3.00	5.00	5.00
Lease lifecycle depth — 20%	4.50	1.50	5.00	2.50	4.00
Enterprise finance & SAMA — 15%	2.50	1.00	4.50	2.50	4.50
5-year TCO — 15%	2.50	1.00	2.00	2.50	1.50
Speed to value — 10%	4.50	3.50	2.00	5.00	1.50
Ownership & exit — 10%	2.50	2.00	3.50	2.50	5.00
Shariah flexibility — 5%	1.00	1.00	3.00	2.00	5.00
WEIGHTED TOTAL /5	2.65	1.45	3.42	3.35	3.85



Custom's lead comes from regulatory, ownership and Shariah criteria — but it carries the two lowest individual scores (speed 1.5, 5-yr TCO 1.5). A365 is the strongest BUY; Custom is the strongest STRATEGY if the 3-year team test passes.

Illustrative 5-year cumulative TCO — SaaS compounds, custom flattens

Cumulative TCO, 200-vehicle operator (est., SAR 000s)



ESTIMATE — order of magnitude only; pricing is quote-based. Excludes migration, integrations, internal staffing. No crossover within 5 yrs at this fleet size; custom crosses SaaS at ~6–8 yrs IF well maintained.

Recommendations — each with its reasoning

R1**Short-term rental operations → local Saudi-native SaaS or configured local build**

Tajeer + ZATCA Phase 2 + Absher are native here; months of middleware delay avoided; switching later is cheap.

R2**Corporate operational + finance leasing → 6-week RFP: Annata A365 vs CarPro LeaseProXL + one local compliance integrator**

Both are evidence-proven at enterprise scale (A365 weighted 3.42); CarPro only conditional on a written post-merger roadmap.

R3**Custom build → keep OPEN but GATED: build only if the RFP shows $\geq 35\%$ must-have gaps AND a funded 3-year product team is committed**

Custom scores highest (3.85) on long-horizon criteria yet weakest on speed (1.5) and 5-yr TCO (1.5) — the conditions convert potential into value.

R4**Rentey → excluded from the shortlist pending verifiable proof**

Single-source vendor page; weighted total 1.45/5 with unknown regulatory readiness; re-admit only with 2+ references + sandbox + written ZATCA/Tajeer statement.

R5**Any SaaS selection → require in writing: in-Kingdom hosting (PDPL/SAMA), data-egress clauses, renewal caps ($\leq 8\%$)**

These three terms decide the real 5-year cost and exit freedom — and vendors never volunteer them.

R6**Before any finance-lease module decision → confirm SAMA scope + ijara structuring with counsel and qualified scholars**

Ijara mechanics (ownership transfer, late-term handling) differ from packaged markup modules; Shariah verdicts are not a software setting.

Decision ask — approve scenario-led shortlisting and vendor due diligence

- 1 Approve the scenario framework + weighted scorecard as the basis for platform choice
- 2 Commission the 6-week RFP: Annata A365 + CarPro LeaseProXL + one local compliance integrator
- 3 Demand from every vendor: 2+ same-size KSA/GCC references, sandbox PoC on our data, written exit clauses
- 4 Verify SAMA scope + ijara structuring with counsel/scholars before any finance-lease module decision
- 5 Confirm ZATCA wave position + Tajeer scope directly with ZATCA and TGA
- 6 Decide build-vs-buy only after RFP results — apply the funded 3-year-team test to the custom option

Decision request at this gate: management approval to run the RFP — no commitment beyond due-diligence spend.

Appendix — sources, confidence, known gaps

VENDORS	CarPro: carprosystems.com (LeaseProXL) · CFI Group (2020 sale to Ibérica) · Auto Rental News (Emotion merger, Mar 2025) · CB Insights
VENDORS	Annata: annata.net (contact, Rental solution) · Craft/LinkedIn · SHEA · Confiz (Sep 2025) · Microsoft Learn (D365 KSA e-invoicing)
VENDORS	Rentey: qoad.com supplier page only — single source, low confidence
REGULATORY	ZATCA detailed guideline (zatca.gov.sa) · SAMA Rulebook (FCCL; Finance Lease M/48) · SDAIA PDPL guide · TGA/Tajeer (tga.gov.sa, elm.sa, rabet.sa)
MARKET	Aljazira Capital Transportation Outlook (SAR 7.5bn FY23 → 11.7bn FY28E) · Research&Markets 2026–2031 (USD 3.07bn, 7.09% CAGR)
TCO	ACM 2025 case study (ERP SaaS vs IaaS) · SitePoint custom-vs-OTS · CISIN framework (vendor-adjacent — framing only)
GAPS	Rentey references unknown · Tajeer scope for long-term leasing unconfirmed (→ TGA/counsel) · Wave 24 cited Jun 2026 (→ verify with ZATCA) · all pricing quote-based
CONFIDENCE	HIGH: vendor identities + regulatory framework · MEDIUM: TCO bands (estimates) · LOW: Rentey capability

Shariah structuring verdicts reserved to qualified scholars; regulatory citations to be confirmed against official Arabic texts. Review: Dec 2026 or upon ZATCA wave change.